

Motivation Letter

Turning complex technologies into focused, scalable business opportunities

To the Executive Leadership Team,

My career began in experimental particle physics at ETH Zurich and CERN. As a lecturer, I learned that knowledge creates value only when it is shared clearly and enables others to act. As a researcher, I helped build complex particle detectors designed to turn theoretical models into measurable evidence. These experiences shaped the way I work today: rigorous in analysis, creative in finding solutions and committed to bringing specialists together around a common purpose.

I then moved rapidly into engineering across a wide range of technologies: vacuum and cryogenic systems, high voltage, optics, space instrumentation, complex thermal processes, hydrogen storage and shock-wave measurement. Moving between fields taught me that knowledge is the foundation, but creativity is what connects it to a new problem. It also trained me to learn quickly, recognise transferable principles and make sound decisions in unfamiliar territory.

In industrial sensing, my focus expanded from technical performance to commercially successful design. I learned to balance specifications with manufacturability, investment requirements and cost of goods. As an engineering leader, I built and developed skilled teams, created structures for collaboration and knowledge transfer, and guided technologies from concept through industrialisation. One sensor portfolio reached approximately 50% of its target segment within three years.

Technology-driven business development brought these capabilities together. I listen to customers to understand their real pain points and willingness to pay, then translate that voice into differentiated but economically realistic product specifications. I develop market-entry options, roadmaps and business cases—including proposals supporting more than CHF 20 million in investment decisions—and present top management with clear choices, assumptions, risks and recommendations.

For me, business development does not end with an approved business case. I steer deployment with sales, equip sales engineers to communicate the value proposition, support them in strategic customer discussions and bring their market feedback into the next decisions. I work with marketing to position and launch the product professionally, while maintaining alignment between customer value, technical capability, production economics and commercial ambition.

I am seeking a mandate from executive management to build or expand a business-development team for advanced industrial technologies. I offer the breadth to connect disciplines, the leadership to grow a capable team and the judgment to convert uncertainty into actionable options and sustainable growth. I would welcome a discussion about where this combination could create the greatest value for your organisation.

Yours sincerely,

Marco Laffranchi